

Chicago Tribune



QUESTIONS? CALL 1-800-TRIBUNE

FRIDAY, APRIL 4, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Was road to teachers union deal worth it?

Johnson's critics looking to pounce on his alliance with CTU

By Nell Salzman, Alice Yin and Jake Sheridan
Chicago Tribune

The day after a tentative Chicago Teachers Union contract was reached, Mayor Brandon Johnson took a victory lap on the pivotal education win — one long-promised and hard-won.

"I said, 'get it done,' and they did," an ebullient Johnson told reporters at City Hall on Tuesday, almost a year after the previous agreement expired. "I'm confident that the people of Chicago are relieved, first of all, that we're not going to have the teachers strike or even a strike vote. It's the first time in 15 years."

Johnson indeed reached this point without Chicago Public Schools classrooms closing, unlike his predecessors Lori Lightfoot and Rahm Emanuel. But it remains to be seen whether the journey to get here was worth it for the mayor and his staunchest labor ally.

Johnson's critics are already pledging to pounce on his close alliance with the teachers union in the 2027 mayoral campaign. They will find ample fodder in the rancorous process that led to this point, along with certain-to-continue tensions among a divided school board, mayor's office and lame-duck CEO Pedro Martinez.

One City Council opponent, downtown Ald. Brian Hopkins, had a succinct answer when asked what the negotiations cost Johnson and the CTU: "Their reputations."

Asked to justify the chaos that got him here, Johnson rattled off contract highlights such as smaller class sizes and higher veteran teacher pay.

"I mean, I could keep going. I'm saying all of it is worth it when we are investing in our public accommodations," the mayor said. "I believe that if the members of this union decide to codify the agreement, it's going to be an incredible win for the people of Chicago."

Lingering liabilities for the mayor:

In the end, CTU supporters and opponents alike did not find much fault with the pending contract, which provides 4% raises in the first year and 4% to 5% per year for the remainder. The fact that the final economic terms were more or less on the table for months while the various factions continued to publicly attack one another and the threat of a strike loomed raises questions about Johnson's ability to close the deal.

Union President Stacy Davis Gates characterized the hiccups along the way as a healthy sign

Turn to Contract, Page 4



Traders work on the floor of the New York Stock Exchange during morning trading Thursday in New York City. The Dow Jones Industrial Average dropped 1,679 points, or 4%, and the Nasdaq composite tumbled 6%. MICHAEL M. SANTIAGO/GETTY

Markets plunge after Trump reveals tariffs

Global sell-off slams stocks; worst day for S&P since 2020

By Stan Choe
Associated Press

NEW YORK — Wall Street shuddered, and a level of shock unseen since COVID-19's outbreak tore through financial markets worldwide Thursday on worries about the damage President Donald Trump's newest set of tariffs could do to economies across continents, including his own.

The S&P 500 sank 4.8%, more than in major markets across

Asia and Europe, for its worst day since the pandemic crashed the economy in 2020. The Dow Jones Industrial Average dropped 1,679 points, or 4%, and the Nasdaq composite tumbled 6%.

Little was spared in financial markets as fear flared about the potentially toxic mix of weakening economic growth and higher inflation that tariffs can create.

Everything from crude oil to Big Tech stocks to the value of the U.S. dollar against other currencies fell. Even gold, which

has hit records recently as investors sought something safer to own, pulled lower. Some of the worst hits walloped smaller U.S. companies, and the Russell 2000 index of smaller stocks dropped 5.9% to pull more than 20% below its record.

Investors worldwide knew Trump was going to announce a sweeping set of tariffs late Wednesday, and fears surrounding it had already pulled Wall Street's main measure of health, the S&P 500 index, 10% below

its all-time high. But Trump still managed to surprise them with "the worst-case scenario for tariffs," said Mary Ann Bartels, chief investment officer at Sanctuary Wealth.

Trump announced a minimum tariff of 10% on imports, with the tax rate running much higher on products from certain countries like China and those from the European Union. It's "plausible" that the tariffs altogether, which would rival levels unseen in roughly a century, could knock down U.S. economic growth by 2

Turn to Markets, Page 4

Northwestern engineers develop tiny pacemaker

Device, smaller than grain of rice, could play big role in future

By Lisa Schencker
Chicago Tribune

A new, tiny pacemaker — smaller than a grain of rice — developed at Northwestern University could play a sizable role in the future of medicine, according to the engineers who

developed it.

Researchers unveiled the device, which they say is the smallest pacemaker in the world, in a study published Wednesday in the peer-reviewed journal Nature.

Though the device is still years away from being used in humans, it could eventually be useful for infants with congenital heart defects and also for adults, the researchers say.

"I think it's really exciting

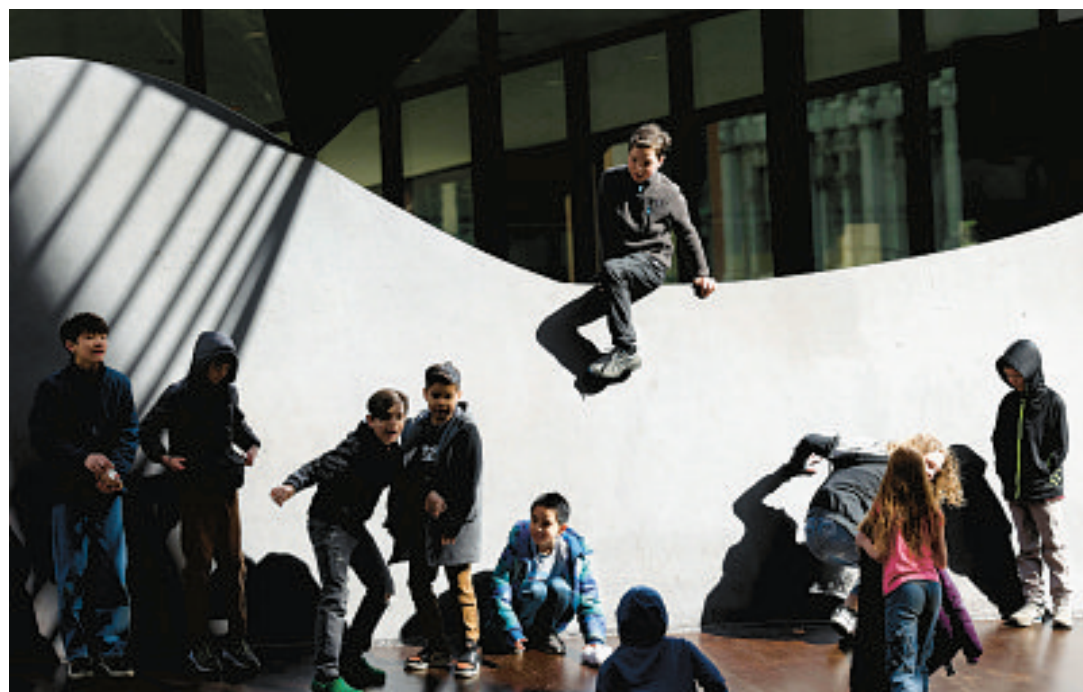
technology that will change how electrical stimulation is done," said Igor Efimov, a Northwestern experimental cardiologist who co-led the study.

The device can be inserted with a catheter or syringe. After it is placed in or on the heart, it's paired with another small, patch-like device worn on the patient's chest. When the device on the chest detects irregular heartbeats



Northwestern engineers unveiled what they say is world's smallest pacemaker. JOHN A. ROGERS/NORTHWESTERN UNIVERSITY

Turn to Pacemaker, Page 5



ANTONIO PEREZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Hitting the 'Homeschool Act'

Children play on the Picasso statue at Daley Plaza in Chicago on Thursday before a news conference to denounce a bill known as the "Homeschool Act." Among other requirements, the legislation would require the Illinois State Board of Education to create a declaration form for whoever is in charge of a homeschooled student to submit to the school district or principal of the public school the child would otherwise attend.

Environmental ordinance prompts hopes, frustrations

The act would address discriminatory planning, zoning, land use policies

By Adriana Pérez
Chicago Tribune

More than a year after its planned introduction, an environmental ordinance that aims to address decades of discriminatory planning, zoning and land-use policies in Chicago will finally be brought before the City Council.

But some community activists are blasting city officials for not making the ordinance available to the public beforehand — a move

they call alienating after a mostly collaborative partnership with Mayor Brandon Johnson's administration.

The ordinance would be the next step after the 2023 release of a cumulative impact assessment that analyzed how exposure to toxins, socioeconomic factors and health conditions vary throughout Chicago. That report was part of a voluntary compliance agreement negotiated with the federal government following a two-year federal investigation that found the city culpable of steering heavy industry away from white commu-

Turn to Ordinance, Page 5

TODAY'S WEATHER



High 51 Low 41

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 12

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
177th year No. 94 © Chicago Tribune

